

Cross-cutting Management Plan (NWFPs)

Tshaidang Shingmen Tshogpa



Name of NWFP Group: Tshaidang Shingmen Tshogpa

Village: Tshaidang

Gewog: Nangkor

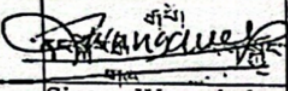
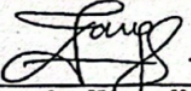
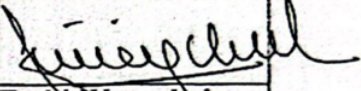
Dzongkhag: Zhemgang

Plan Period: September 2024 – September 2034 (*2nd revision*)

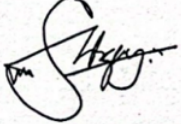
Approval Sheet

Name of NWFP Management and Marketing Group	Tshaidang Shingmen Tshogpa
Village(s)	Tshaidang
Gewog	Nangkor
Dzongkhag/Dungkhag	Zhemgang
No. of households	30
Area (ha)	264.26
Plan period	September 2024 – September 2034

Prepared and submitted for Approval

	Chairperson of NWFP Management and Marketing Group	Gup of the Gewog	Head FRPMS of Division/Park	Chief Forestry Officer of Division/Park
Signature:				
Name:	Sonam Leki	Singye Wangchuk	Jangchu Wangdi	Tashi Wangchuk
Date:				

Reviewed and recommended for approval

	Reviewing Officer, FRPMD	Chief Forestry Officer, FRPMD
Signature		
Name	Kezang Wangmo	Sonam Tobgay
Date	07/10/2024	07/10/2024

Approved by:



(Director)

Department of Forests and Park Services, MoENR

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Acronyms

BDBL	Bhutan Development Bank Limited
DFO	Divisional Forest Office
hh	Household
ITMS	Institute of Traditional Medicine Services
Kg	Kilogram
Km	Kilometer
ac	Acre
ha	Hectare
KNC	Khenrig Namsum Cooperatives
NWFP	Non-wood Forest Produce
FRPMD	Forest Resources Planning and Management Division
FRPMS	Forest Resources Planning and Management Section

Part A: NWFP Management and Marketing Plan

1. Background

Tshaidang Shingmen Tshogpa is located under Nangkor gewog, Zhemgang Dzongkhag. It is an hour's drive from Gewog Center at Buli. The community has access to basic amenities like Out Reach Clinic (ORC), school, electricity, water supply, motorable road and telecommunication network. Agriculture is primary source of livelihood in the village and people cultivate maize, rice, potatoes, beans, cabbage, chilli and cash crops like orange and cardamom. They also depend on forest for timber, firewood and Non-wood Forest Product (NWFP) for additional income generation.

The village has 30 households and all are registered member of Tshaidang Shingmen Tshogpa. There are various NWFPs found in their locality and the group has selected *Piper mullesua*, *Rubia cordifolia* and *Dendrocalamus hamiltonii* for management and marketing. The management area consists of 5 blocks, encompassing total area of 653 acres. Three blocks namely Yungar, Backalingchen and Kirpho will be managed for *Piper mullesua* (Pipla/ Ragtang_Kh), Yechur block will be managed for *Rubia cordifolia* (Tsuth) and Sueling block will be managed for *Dendrocalamus hamiltonii* shoots (Pagshi).

During the previous management plan period, the group collected and sold NWFPs for one season and rest of the seasons were inactive due to the pandemic. This is the 2nd reviewed management plan and the previous plan had expired in September, 2022. Before reviewing the management plan, a comprehensive consultation meeting with the management group members was conducted to understand the reason for shortcomings and to assess their interest in continuing further management. Having captured their interest in continued management of NWFPs, Divisional Forest Office (DFO), Zhemgang provided technical support to the group in resource assessment and preparation of management plan. The management plan will guide the group members to implement the better management practices mainly on proper harvesting technique and other aspect of management.

2. Goal and objectives:

- To strengthen community institution to manage NWFP.
- To harvest NWFP sustainably through proper management prescriptions.
- To enhance livelihood income through sale of NWFP.

3. Description of NWFPs present in the area demarcated for management.

Pipla/Ragtang (*Piper mullesua*):

It is a perennial plant growing up to 1 to 2 meter in height and has a thick greenish leave. The plant has a unisexual reproduction unit with male and female plants and only few plants bear fruits. Pipla grows widely under the canopy of broadleaf forest or open area at an altitude range of 200-2200 masl. The plants thrive best in damp and moist soil with good shade. Its fruit start ripening in September. The management group will be collecting Pipla from three blocks namely Yungar, Backalingchen and Kirpho blocks. All the blocks collectively measure 440 acres and are located at an hour's walking distance from the village.

Tsuth (*Rubia cordifolia*):

It can grow up to height of to 1.5 m. The evergreen leaves are 5–10 cm long and 2–3 cm broad, produced in whorls of 4-7 starlike around the central stem. It climbs with tiny hooks at the leaves and stems. The flowers are small (3–5 mm across), with five pale yellow petals, in dense racemes, and appear from June to August, followed by small (4–6 mm diameter) red to black berries. The roots can be over 1 m long, up to 12 mm thick. It prefers loamy soils with a constant level of

moisture. The management group will be collecting *Rubia cordifolia* from Yechur block (96 acres), located at an hour’s walk from the village.

Pagshi (*Dendrocalamus hamiltonii*):

Culms to 9 cm to 25cm in diameter, strong pendulous above, densely covered in persistent, brown and white, furry and wax; wall thin; branches fewer toward base, center branch to 5cm in diameter, smallest branches curving from clump, nodes with dense, long aerial roots. The management group will be collecting Pagshi from Sueling block located at the distance of 1 hour walk from the village.

Table 1. Brief description of NWFPs for commercial harvesting in each season

<i>NWFP name</i>	<i>Harvesting area(s) (name)</i>	<i>Parts harvested</i>	<i>Use/purpose (traditional & others)</i>	<i>Harvesting season (months)</i>	<i>Estimated quantity for harvest in a season/year</i>
<i>Piper mullesua</i> (Pipla/ Raktang_Kh)	Yungar, Backalingchen & Kirpho	Fruits	Spice/ medicine	September to November	1000Kgs
<i>Rubia cordifolia</i> (Tsuth_Kh)	Yechur	Entire plant	Dye, medicine	November to February	1000kgs
<i>Dendrocalamus hamiltonii</i> (Pagshi)	Sueling	Shoot	Pickle	June to September	450kgs

4.Prescriptions for sustainable harvesting

The NWFP management group members have to adhere to specific procedure for the sustainable management of resources.

- The Chairperson will consult with forest office and obtain permit for collection during the onset of harvesting season.
- The Chairperson will announce starting date for harvesting only after obtaining required permits from forest office.
- Only one member from each household will be entitled for collection of NWFP products.
- Collection will be done within the demarcated area only.
- Harvesting prescriptions will be strictly followed by the collectors (Table 2).
- The Chairperson will maintain proper record of harvest and sale of NWFPs for monitoring and evaluation.
- Chairperson will notify the forest office on completion of harvesting the NWFPs.

Table 2. Prescriptions for sustainable harvesting of Piper mullesua

<i>NWFP Species</i>	<i>Harvesting prescription</i>
<i>Piper mullesua</i> (Pipla/ Ragtang_Kh)	- Collect fruits only when fully mature. - Harvest fruits only after the announced starting date for harvesting that are usually in September-November. - Harvest fruits only by hand picking without damaging, cutting or uprooting the entire plant.
<i>Rubia cordifolia</i> (Tsuth)	- Use sharp scissors for the harvesting of the upper part of the plant. - Cut the plant at 5 cm above ground level. - Leave at least 10% of the plants without collecting or harvesting any raw materials from them (these plants shall act as seed plants for natural regeneration). - Do not collect roots. - Do not uproot entire plants

<i>Dendrocalamus hamiltonii</i> (Pagshi)	• Collect bamboo shoots to a maximum of 25% from a clump • Cut bamboo-shoots with a sharp knife at the ground level without damaging or wounding the other healthy ones • After cutting and collecting the bamboo-shoot, cover that void place with top soil • Protect the remaining shoots and let them further develop into culms
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5.Location sketch map of the NWFP harvesting areas

Sl.no	Location	NWFP	Area (ac)	Distance from the center (Village)
1	Yungar Backalingchen Kirpho	<i>Piper mullesua</i> (<i>Ragtang</i>)	121 177 142	25minutes 30minutes 30minutes
2	Yechur	<i>Rubia cordifolia</i> (<i>Tsuth</i>)	99	45minutes
3	Sueling	<i>Dendrocalamus himaltonii</i> (<i>Pagshi</i>)	117	1 hours

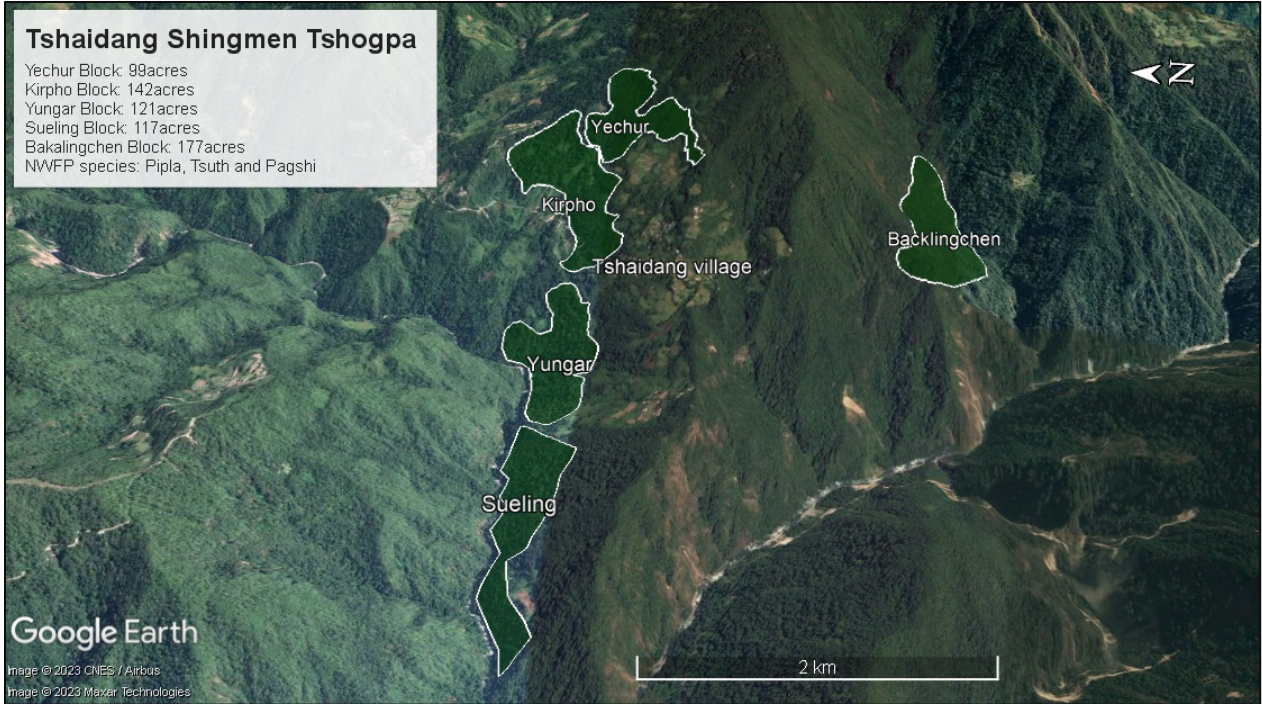


Figure 1. Map of NWFP collection area

6.Marketing and sales plan

Table 3. Marketing and sales plan

NWFP	Potential market	Estimated quantity for sale per season (unit)	Form of Products (dry/fresh)	Expected price/unit (Nu.)	Total (Nu.)
Pipla, (<i>Piper mullesua</i>)	Gelephu	1000kgs	dry	120	1,20000
Tsuth (<i>Rubia cordifolia</i>)	Gelephu/ India	1000kgs	dry	150	1,50000
Pagshi (<i>Dendrocalamus himaltonii</i>)	KNC/ Zhemgang	450kgs	fresh	60	27,000

7.Marketing arrangement

The marketing arrangements for Non-Wood Forest Products (NWFP) involves following strategies to promote sustainable utilization of the resources.

Table 4.Procedures for NWFP harvesting, marketing and sharing of income

Activity	Brief description on how the activities shall carry out
Harvesting of products	• The Chairperson of NWFP group will obtain harvesting/collection permit from forest office in writing. • The Chairperson will announce starting date for harvesting only after obtaining required permits from forest office. • Only one member from each household will be collect NWFP for the first week and after that no limits is set for member involvement for collection. • Harvesting prescriptions will be strictly followed by the collectors. • Chairperson shall inform Range Office on completion of harvest.
Postharvest practices	• The collectors are responsible for post-harvest processing of NWFPs.
Marketing of products	• The NWFPs will be handed over to the executive committee members for marketing after post-harvest processing. • The executive committee members will sell the produce in presence of the group members to maintain transparency. In future the group plans to construct a common sale counter at the center to facilitate marketing of the NWFPs products.
Identification of buyers	• The Chairperson supported by other executive committee members will monitor and explore the demand from nearby institutes, agents, companies and other business groups. • Support will also be sought from Department of Agriculture and Marketing Cooperatives (DAMC)
Price fixing	• The executive committee members will coordinate.
Income sharing	• An amount equivalent to sale value of 2kg Pipla from each member household will be collected and deposited in the community development fund. Sale proceeds from balance quantity of Pipla shall be paid to respective member household. • The full amount of sale proceeds from Tsuth and Pagshi shall be paid to respective member household.
Raising of community development fund	• A joint account in the name of the group will be opened under BDBL Branch Office located at Buli. The account shall be managed by the executive committee members on behalf of the group. • Annual membership fees, penalties and certain amount of sale proceeds will be deposited in the community development fund.
Payment to committee members for their service	Not applicable

8.Benefit to the members

All the group members will have equal rights to sustainably harvest NWFPs from the area demarcated for management. In addition to sale proceeds of Pipla after deduction of amount to be contributed for community development fund, each member household shall be paid the full amount earned from sale of Tsuth and Pagshi.

Table 5. Financial projection and benefits to the members from NWFP sales

Sl. No	Particulars	Products (names)			Total Amount (Nu)
		Pipla	Tsuth	Pagshi	
1	Revenues				
a	Total quantity (unit)	1000kg	1000kg	450kg	

b	Market price (Nu per unit)	120	150	60	
c	Total revenues from forest product sales (a*b)	120000	150000	27000	297000
A	Total revenues				297000
2	Expenses				
a	Packaging materials	-	-	-	-
b	Royalty	1000kg @20 = 20000	1000kg @16 = 16000	-	36000
c	Transportation costs				5000
d	Compensation fee to executive committee for marketing products	-	-	-	-
e	Contribution to community development fund	60kg @120 = 7200	-	-	7200
f	Incidental expenses	-	-	-	-
B	Total expenses				48200
C	Total benefit (net-income) of group members (Total revenues A – Total expenses B)				248800
D	Average income to group members (C/ no of group members)				8293
E	Price per unit paid to group members (C/1a)				101.55

9.Benefits to the group

The amount equivalent to sale proceed from 2kg of Pipla from each member household will be collected and deposited in the community development fund. Any member who does not harvest Pipla will also need to pay amount equivalent to 2kgs and deposit in the group account. The expenditures incurred in the name of management group shall be met from the community development fund.

Table 6. Financial projection of the benefits to the group, the community development fund

Sl. No	Particulars	Amount (Nu)
	Revenues	
1	Membership registration fees (30hh @300)	9000
2	Annual contribution	-
3	Contribution to the Community Development Fund (CDF) from sales of Pipla (30hh @2kg = 60kg @120 = 7200/-)	7200
A	Total revenues	16200
	Expenses (only include expenses that will be paid from the group funds)	-
		
B	Total Expenses	-
C	Balance: Total revenues – Total expenses	16200

Part B: Group Regulation and Norms (By-Law)

10. NWFP management & marketing group	
10.1 Membership arrangement and resignation 10.2. Responsibilities and rights of members:	Any household with census recorded in Tshaidang village and residing in the area can join the group. However, acceptance in the group will be made only by the group members through meeting. <u>Responsibilities and rights of members:</u> • Implement annual activities that are reflected in the management plan. • Manage the area in adherence to the management plan and refrain from doing illegal activities. • Attend ad-hoc/ planned meetings or activities for development of the group. • Attend any training related to NWFP. • Choose or reject committee members for better management of the group. <u>Procedure for becoming new members:</u> • Any household wishing to become members in the group shall submit application to the Chairperson. • The applicant should be 18 years of age to become a member. • The application shall be put forward in the general meeting for discussion and every member has right to accept or reject the application. • Membership fee of Nu.300/- shall be levied upon registration. <u>Procedure for leaving the group:</u> • Any member wishing to discontinue their membership has right to do so. However, he/she should submit application to the Chairperson. • He/she can leave the group after discussing with the committee members. • Member leaving the group will not be allowed to avail their benefits from the group fund. • If their children wish to join as a member in future, they have to follow the procedure set to become new member.
11. Executive committee of NWFP management and marketing group	
11.1 Chairperson	Name of Chairperson: Sonam Leki Contact No.17414297 <u>Responsibilities of Chairperson:</u> • Explore market for NWFPs. • Obtain collection permit from forest office during the onset of harvesting season. • Coordinate and plan activities for the user group along with the members and other stakeholders. • Coordinate and conduct meetings with members for development of the group. • Resolve conflict among group members. • Submit annual progress report to forest office. • Maintain record of all the group activities.
11.2 Secretary	Name of Secretary: Dechen Tshomo Contact No. <u>Responsibilities of Secretary:</u> • Officiate in absence of Chairperson.

	• Assist Chairperson in coordinating and planning group activities. • Explore market for NWFPs. • Maintain records of any activities conducted by the group. • Maintain attendance record while conducting meeting and group activities. • Record minutes of meeting.
11.3 Treasurer	Name of Treasurer: Jigme Yangzom Contact No. <u>Responsibilities of Treasurer:</u> • Officiate in absence of Chairperson and Secretary. • Collect annual membership fees, fines, amount from sale proceeds and deposit in the group account. • Maintain proper financial records in favor of the group. • Present financial status/ progress report during general meeting. • Assist Chairperson and Secretary in coordinating and planning group activities.
12. Tenure of committee member	• Their tenure shall be till the plan period ends. • However, if a committee member does not fulfill his/her responsibilities, misbehave and threaten the group's network, he/she shall be immediately replaced and be deprived of such opportunity in future.
13. Incentives to the committee members	• If the committee members have worked positively towards betterment of group, he/she shall be re-elected. This is to reward the individual for his/her dedicated service to the group.
14. Sources for generation of group fund	
14.1 Membership registration fees. 14.2 Annual contribution 14.3 Collection from sale proceeds	• Membership fees of Nu.300 per member household shall be collected annually. • An amount equivalent to sale proceeds of 2kg Pipla per member household shall be collected and deposited in the group fund. • Amount realized as penalties shall be deposited in the group fund.
15. Group fund management and utilization	• A joint account in favor of the group shall be opened under BDBL, Buli. • Annual membership fees, fines and amount from sale proceeds shall be deposit in the group account. • The joint account will be managed by Executive Committee members. • Any expenditure incurred in the name of the group will be met from community development fund. • When the fund accumulates more than two hundred thousand, the fund will be utilized for community rituals, supporting the poor and disaster affected household. • If the group gets dissolved under unforeseen circumstances, all the fund accumulated shall be equally divided among the members.
16. Conflict resolution	• If any dispute arises within the group members, the matter shall be forwarded to Chairperson for settlement. If the case cannot be resolved, the matter shall be further forwarded to the Gewog Administration for final decision. • In case there is conflict between the NWFP group and outsiders, the case shall be forwarded to Divisional Forest Office, Zhemgang and Gewog Administration by the Chairperson.

17. Meeting and purpose	In order to plan and discuss activities for the management of NWFPs, meeting will be conducted as follows; • General Assembly: All the members shall attend the meeting to discuss and plan activities before harvesting season; during April month every year. • Committee member: This meeting is mainly to discuss the planned activities as well as prepare progress reports (financial and physical) during the November month.
18. Penalties	• If any of the members violate the harvesting rules, he/she shall be fined Nu.500 and will refrain from harvesting for rest of the season and subsequent season. • Absentees during work and meetings shall be fined Nu: 215/- per occasion. • Collection of NWFP during the off season shall be fined Nu.500 per person. • Marketing of NWFPs without notice of committee members, he/she shall be fined Nu.500 per occasion. • Committee members not performing their duties as required shall be fined Nu.500. • If group members do not obey the instruction of committee members, he/she shall be fined Nu.50 per person • If any members sell NWFPs to outsider without prior notice of the group, he/she shall be fined Nu: 1500 per occasion. • If any outsider collects any NWFP products from designated area of the group, he/she shall be fined Nu. 1000 per occasion

Powers of the Department

The Department has the right to terminate the NWFP management and marketing group in case of any violation of the management plan prescription or in the event of inability to carry out the activities as per the plan.

Appendix I: Annual NWFP reporting form

Dzongkhag/Dungkhag:
Name of NWFP management and marketing group:
Gewog:
Villages:
Total number of Households:

NWFP Species	Quantity collected in a year	Qty sold in a year	Price received by the group per unit	Total income (Nu)	Description on resource availability	Remarks

Appendix II: List of NWFP Group members

Sl.No.	Name	House No.	Thram No.
1	Pema Lhamo	Wa-4-56	381
2	Kelzang	Wa-4-58	383
3	Pema Lhazom	Wa-4-61	362
4	Tshering Cheki	Wa-4-63	361
5	Delak Drukpa	Wa-4-64	370
6	Ugyen Lhamo	Wa-4-62	386
7	Pema Wangmo	Wa-4-77	372
8	Tshering Yangchen	Wa-4-68	364
9	Deki	Wa-4-60	375
10	Chekimo	Wa-4-65	360
11	Tashi Lhamo	Wa-4-81	388
12	Tenzin Pema	Wa-4-73	373
13	Dechen Tshomo	Wa-4-74	781
14	Tharpa Lhamo	Wa-4-69	374
15	Yangzom	Wa-4-59	380
16	Chezom	Wa-4-70	394
17	Dorji Lhamo	Wa-4-74	359
18	Nima Dema	Wa-4-73	384
19	Tshewang Choden	Wa-4-67	363
20	Tashi Dema	Wa-4-76	389
21	Karma Pema	Wa-4-71	365
22	Sherab Zangmo	Wa-4-80	367
23	Tashila	Wa-4-75	369
24	Kinley Wangmo	Wa-4-78	366
25	Yuden	Wa-4-66	385
26	Damchen Dema	Wa-4-62	811
27	Dorji Lhamo	Wa-4-80	869
28	Leki Wangmo	Wa-4-68	859
29	Ugyen Lhamo	Wa-4-61	386
30	Pema Wangmo	Wa-4-77	372